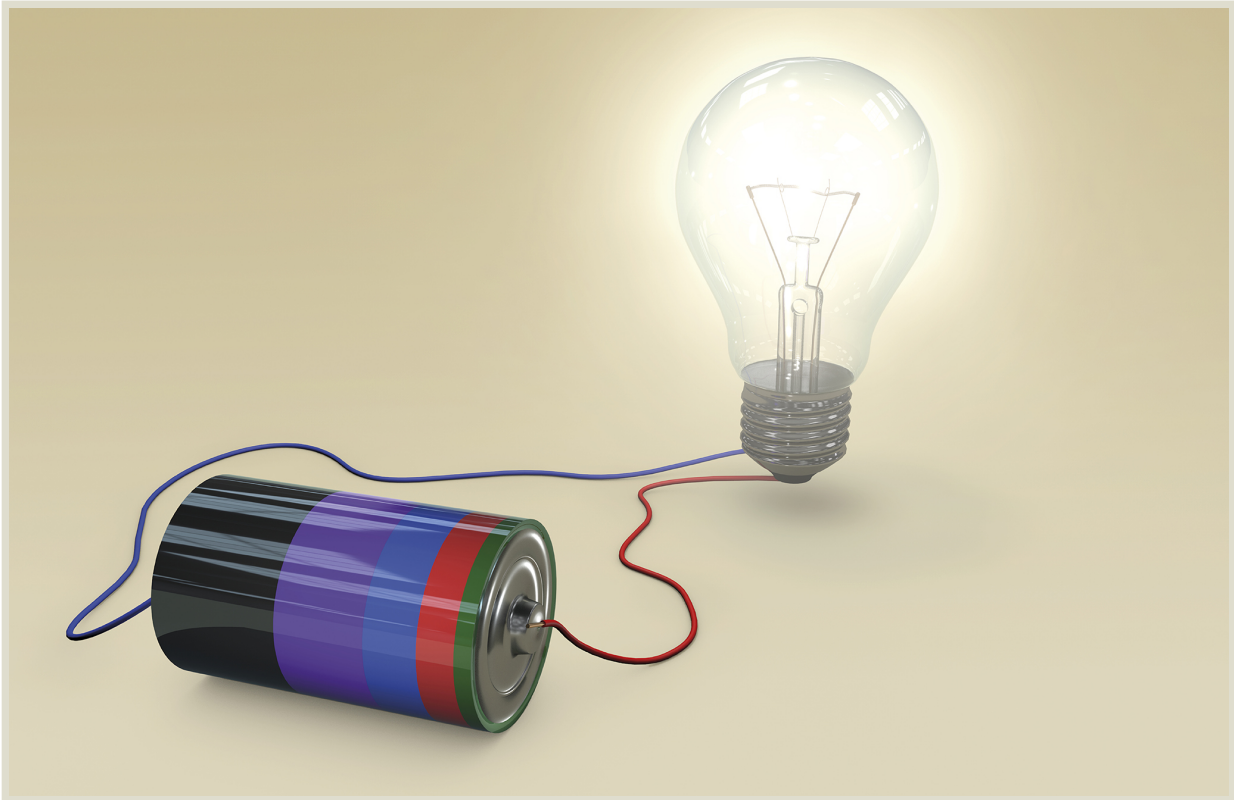




Keeping the lights on

Establishing secure sources of energy is a preoccupation of many countries around the world. At the same time, alternative sources of energy need to be found before fossil fuels run out.



FOSSIL FUELS

Fossil fuels—coal, oil, and natural gas—are made from buried remains of living things. They provide over 80 percent of our energy needs. Many of these fuel reserves are in politically unstable places such as the Middle East, so some countries are developing sources, including oil tar sands and oil shale, from which it is harder to extract oil but which are closer to hand. Even so, the world may run out of oil within the next half century.